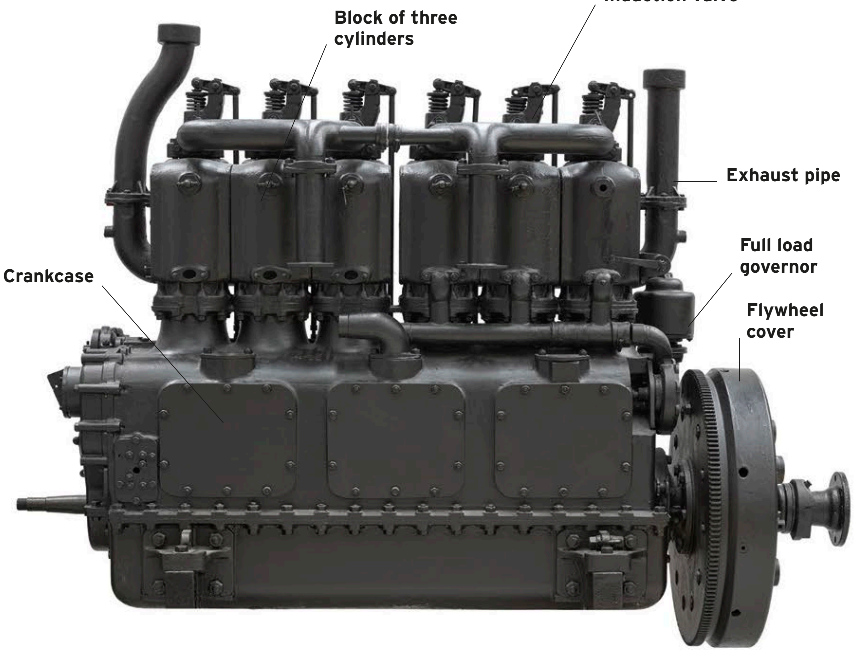
OTHER KEY ENGINES

From the sheer variety of engine types employed in tanks through the years, it is clear that their designers were given a very free reign. Some stuck closely to existing principles and produced inline units, others chose to employ radial power plants originally intended for aircraft—and then there were those who thought laterally, producing units like the Chrysler A57 Multibank, which could reasonably be described as a multiple radial. Despite its unconventional character, it proved to be extremely reliable, although routine maintenance tasks on it, such as changing spark plugs, were rather difficult.

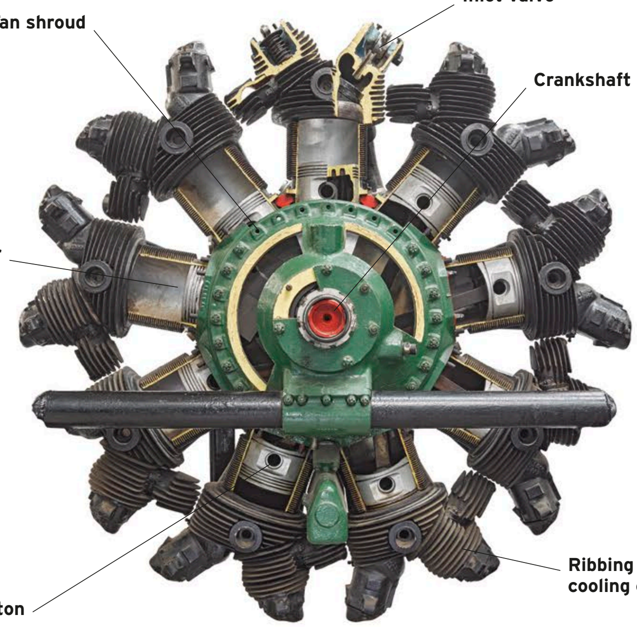
RICARDO 150HP



Harry Ricardo, an extremely talented independent engine designer, was asked to solve the problem of the telltale smoke produced by the Daimler unit installed in the first generation of British tanks. Instead of adapting the engine, he came up with a new design that produced significantly more power, and which was adopted for the Mark V tank.

MARK V TANK

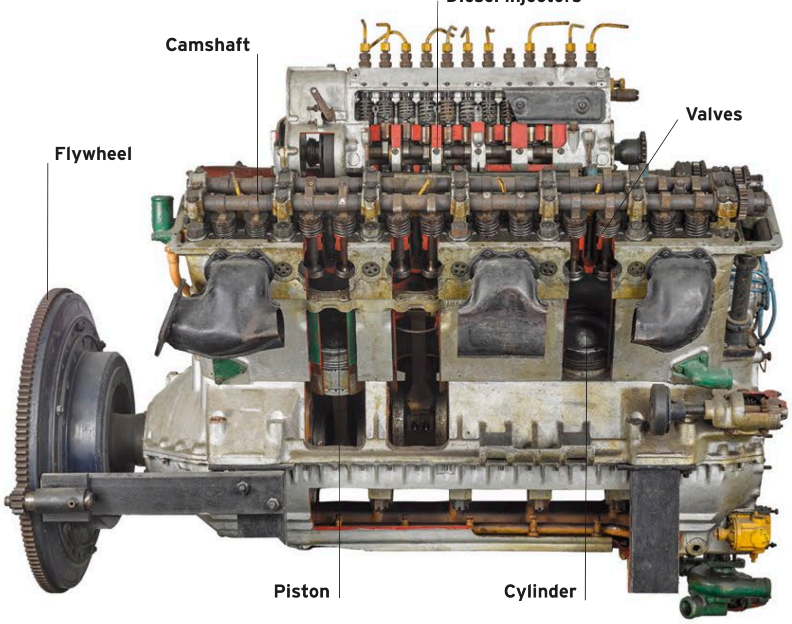
WRIGHT CONTINENTAL R-975



In 1939, the US Army chose a version of the supercharged, air-cooled Wright R-975 radial engine to power a new generation of tanks, starting with the M2 Medium. Produced by Continental Motors, it later found its way into variants of the M3 Grant/Lee, M4 Shermans, and the M18 Hellcat tank destroyer.

M18 HELLCAT

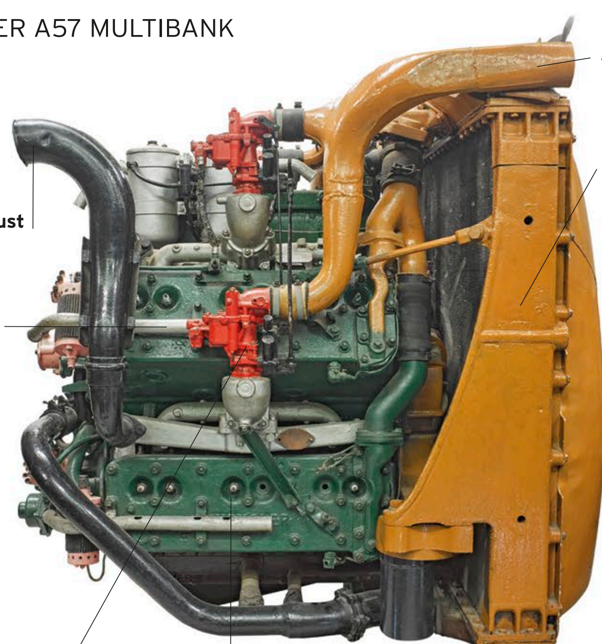
KHARKIV V-2



Until the T-34 appeared, all Soviet tanks had gasoline engines. The designer of the powerplant for the new tank stuck to the V-12 arrangement of the T-28, but switched to diesel fuel, and reduced the size and capacity (from 46.9 liters to 38.8 liters) while achieving the same 500 bhp output.

T-34

CHRYSLER A57 MULTIBANK



Engineers at Chrysler's new Detroit Tank Arsenal were instructed to come up with an alternative to the Wright radial engine, and took an innovative approach, using five off-the-shelf 6-cylinder blocks and mating them to a purpose-built crankcase, the 30 pistons driving a single crankshaft. No other changes were needed to produce 425 hp.

M4A4 SHERMAN